



Circle of Young Humanitarians

2023/2024
ANNUAL
REPORT

Preface

Dear members and supporters of the Circle of Young Humanitarians,

The past year was marked by the first Young Humanitarian Summit held on March 25 and 26, 2023 in Zurich. We are pleased that the two-day event with the aim to present ways for everyone to contribute to the humanitarian world was sold out.

After the ongoing war in Ukraine, which presents the world with complex challenges and requires efforts from all parts of society, in October 2023 renewed hostilities between Israel and Hamas shook the world.

Besides organizing the first Young Humanitarian Summit, through the tireless efforts of our dedicated members and volunteers, we were able to organize two other events and awareness campaigns, including a *Humanitarian Enrichment Forum* on financing the humanitarian world and a *Humanitarian Challenge Campaign* in collaboration with Open Your Eyes Fotofestival on the topic of the UN's Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

A big thank you to all our members, volunteers, sponsors, and partners for all the support. Without all of you, this past year would not have been shaped like it was. We hope for continued support and look forward to another year.

Sincerely,

Board of the Circle of Young Humanitarians

Nilani Sunthar, Dominik Haupt, Kay von Mérey, Alina Eichrodt (from left to right)



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Who We Are

The Circle of Young Humanitarians is a politically neutral non-profit association based in Zurich that was established by students and young professionals in collaboration with the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) in 2021. Since January 2022, the Circle of Young Humanitarians is an official association in Zurich.

We believe that what young people think about the challenges we face today will impact the direction of the world in the future. Therefore, we aim to address young people's views on current and emerging global humanitarian issues in an open and effective dialogue.

To do so, the Circle of Young Humanitarians offers a platform for young people to come together, experience the humanitarian worlds, receive new insights, and make a meaningful difference. With a constructive and solution-oriented approach, the CYH strives to address young people's views on armed conflicts and other humanitarian emergencies through open dialogue and awareness raising. Thereby, we hope to inspire and empower people to create a positive impact in our communities and beyond and to contribute to the global effort of preventing and responding to humanitarian crises.



Transition and Tribute

Remembering our roots, the Circle of Young Humanitarians was founded in 2021 by three young humanitarians: Kay von Mérey, Jessica Eberhart, and Leonie Basler. In the last 2.5 years, they have successfully expanded their team to 40+ members, fostering the growth of the CYH community and impacting hundreds of people online and through events. The founders' enthusiasm, vision, and the immense dedication and hard work of the whole interdisciplinary team have been essential to the initiative's success.

Sadly in November 2023, after an amazing CYH journey, it was time to say goodbye to Leonie Basler and Jessica Eberhart. A huge thank you to the two co-founders for their important work and for making the association what it is today. Their hard work and strong dedication have made a lasting impact and shaped our mission. Excitingly, they are now part of the CYH's Advisory Board.

Some impressions from the founders: Kay von Mérey, Jessica Eberhart, Leonie Basler



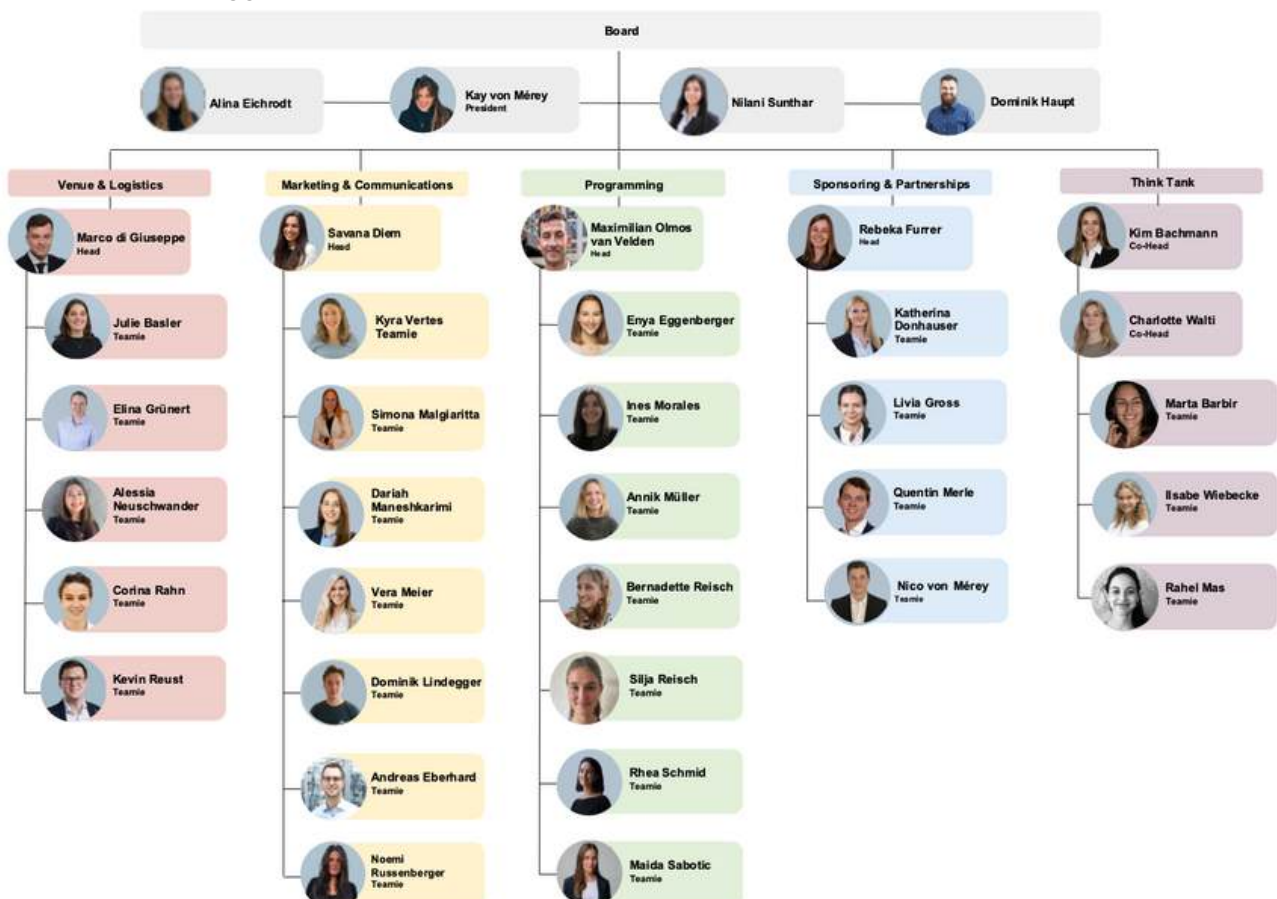
Board and Team

Since November 2023, the Board comprises four members: Kay von Mérey (President), Alina Eichrodt, Nilani Sunthar, and Dominik Haupt. Alina Eichrodt has been part of the CYH from the beginning and brings extensive experience from her prior roles in Marketing & Communications and Programming. Dominik Haupt and Nilani Sunthar, who joined in 2023, offer diverse backgrounds and a shared passion for humanitarian work.



Dominik Haupt, Alina Eichrodt, Kay von Mérey, Nilani Sunthar (from left to right)

Since last year, the team has grown substantially. In 2023, the Circle of Young Humanitarians counts more than 30 members, who devote their time on a voluntary basis. Last year, the four existing teams, marketing & communication, sponsoring & partnerships, venue & logistics, and programming, were complemented by a fifth team, the think tank. Each team is led by a head and has up to seven team members. Additionally, four board members oversee the CYH's strategy, and seven consultants assist with specific issues.



Structure as of November 2023.

What We Do

The Circle of Young Humanitarians aims to bridge the humanitarian worlds to the next generation in innovative ways that resonate with young people's values. We do this by organizing a series of events and projects that follow a two-pillar approach of giving and receiving.

Humanitarian Challenge Campaign

On one hand, we believe in the power of giving, and that young people can make a meaningful impact on the world by taking action. To this end, we organize Humanitarian Challenge Campaigns that offer young people the possibility to volunteer, donate, or raise awareness. Through these campaigns, we hope to inspire young people to become active, engaged members of their communities and to make a difference in the world.



Humanitarian Enrichment Forum

On the other hand, we believe that young people can benefit greatly from connecting with organizations and diverse experts from the humanitarian worlds. Our Humanitarian Enrichment Forums offer young people the opportunity to expand their knowledge, network, and experiences through a range of discussions and inputs. Our aim is to create an environment for mutual learning and collaboration.

Young Humanitarian Summit

The two pillars come together hand-in-hand during our annual Young Humanitarian Summit. During two days, participants come together and engage in critical conversations and explore how we can work together to create positive change. Through this Summit, we aim to inspire young people to take action and to equip them with the knowledge, skills, and connections they need to become effective change-makers in their communities and beyond.

Partnerships

ICRC Patronage

The Circle of Young Humanitarians is proud to work in close collaboration with the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) since 2021. In particular, we are honoured to have held the first Young Humanitarian Summit under the patronage of the ICRC.

A special thank you to David Dandres, Romain Zappella, Alja Sieber, Julia Reus and Sophie Heigl, our main contact partners from the ICRC. We have held regular monthly meetings with them, and during busy periods, even weekly meetings to ensure the success of the first Young Humanitarian Summit. We are grateful for this invaluable partnership, their support and advice throughout the year.



Partners of the Young Humanitarian Summit 2024

A big thank you goes to our partners for the first Young Humanitarian Summit. Without their support, the event would not have been possible.

Main Partner



Humanitarian Gold Partner



Summit Gold Partners



Zürich

Schweizerische Eidgenossenschaft
Confédération suisse
Confederazione Svizzera
Confederaziun svizra
Swiss Agency for Development
and Cooperation SDC

Main Creative Partner

aroma

Main Beverage Partner



Advisory Board

Our Advisory Board members offer guidance and expertise on various aspects, including overall strategy, branding, networking, fundraising and personal development. The Board members of the Circle of Young Humanitarians meet the members of the Advisory Board about three times a year to discuss current challenges and opportunities and receive valuable advice and support. The Advisory Board is chaired by Esther Schaufelberger for a term of two years.



Esther Schaufelberger



Mahmoud Youssef



Heta Liljander



Stephanie Cox



Leonie Basler



Jessica Eberhart



Walter Fust



Katharina Ohnmacht

Review of first quarter of 2023

In 2023, the Circle of Young Humanitarians was busy with various activities. Mid-February, Jessica Eberhart represented the Circle of Young Humanitarians at the International Cooperation (IC) Forum. At the Youth4Solution part, she took the opportunity and talked to the Swiss Federal Councilor, Ignazio Cassis.

In February all our members gathered for a weekend called the “Circle Days” to work on the last preparations for the Young Humanitarian Summit in March. The CYH team designed posters, discussed the stage plan, prepared the participants’ badges, and much more to ensure the event would run smoothly. On March 16 and 17, 2023, we held our first Young Humanitarian Summit. Tickets were sold out and we welcomed over 300 participants. With the event we aimed to foster an interdisciplinary and intergenerational exchange on the far-reaching field of humanitarian assistance.



Review of the Circle Year 2023/24



In June 2023, Kay and Jessica were invited to speak on stage to represent the next generation at the 50th anniversary of Swiss Humanitarian Aid (SHA). It was an incredible experience to talk about the CYH's work in front of 600 people.



In July at the Humanitarian Enrichment Forum 2023, we discussed the financial situation and challenges of humanitarian organisations.



In October, at the Humanitarian Challenge Campaign, we supported the "Open Your Eyes" initiative to promote the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) through a photo exhibition across Zurich.



We ended the year in December with a mulled wine stand, sponsored by Vinarius. For every glass sold, the profit was donated to the CYH to support our mission of bridging the humanitarian worlds to the next generation.



We started 2024 with an ambitious agenda, focusing on organizing the second Humanitarian Summit. With this year's theme, "Exploring Humanitarian Worlds," the second edition sought to address the field of humanitarian assistance throughout the lifecycle of conflict.

Humanitarian Enrichment Forum

Financing for Change



"Financing for Change," brought together humanitarian experts and the next generation to tackle some of the toughest questions on financing the humanitarian sector. This engaging forum featured a distinguished panel of speakers from renowned organizations, fostering a rich dialogue on the future of humanitarian funding.



We were honoured to have Esther Schaufelberger, the Head of Philanthropy at Médecins Sans Frontières (MSF) Switzerland, share her invaluable insights. David Dandrès, the Head of Private Donor Engagement & Partnerships - Switzerland at the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), also contributed his expertise on engaging private donors and forging impactful partnerships. Andreas Bröchle, the Chief Financial Officer at Save the Children Switzerland, provided a comprehensive perspective on financial management within the humanitarian context. The discussion was moderated by Dr. Florian Hohmann from the University of St. Gallen. His adept facilitation ensured a dynamic and productive exchange of ideas, highlighting the critical challenges and opportunities in humanitarian financing.



We were thrilled to witness an intergenerational and interdisciplinary dialogue, fostering innovative ideas and solutions to ensure the sustainability and impact of humanitarian efforts.

Humanitarian Challenge Campaign

The Value of SDGs

From October 2 to 8, 2023, young people volunteered at the visitor center for the "Open Your Eyes Fotofestival". The CYH's aim was not only to support the festival ourselves but also to recruit new volunteers and inspire others to get involved. Consequently, about half of the volunteers were from within CYH, while the other half were individuals from the broader community, without whom this event would not have been possible. A big thank you to all our volunteers!

On the final day of the CYH Take-over, the CYH met at the SDG 16 (Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions) exhibit at Seebad Enge. There, we exchanged ideas and engaged in discussions with other visitors about the significance and goals of SDG 16. This interaction provided a valuable opportunity to connect with interested visitors and share insights on promoting peace, justice, and strong institutions.



Young Humanitarian Summit

Exploring the Humanitarian Worlds

The Young Humanitarian Summit held on March 16 & 17, 2024, in Zurich, aimed to foster an intergenerational and interdisciplinary exchange and to empower young people to reflect upon humanitarian assistance and contribute to the humanitarian world.

The two-day event brought together prominent humanitarian organizations and pivotal humanitarian leaders to explore how humanitarian assistance manifests itself throughout the life-cycle of conflict. Within this framework, the Young Humanitarian Summit aimed to explore and critically question the future role of humanitarian assistance. Through panel discussions, hands-on workshops, and immersive experiences, participants were encouraged to take action, whether through volunteering, donations, or mindful engagement, regardless of background. The fair allowed participants to connect with humanitarian organisations offering concrete opportunities to volunteer.

Esteemed speakers and leading organizations, including the ICRC, MSF, SDC, UNHCR, Swiss Red Cross, Save the Children, NZZ, UNICEF Switzerland & Liechtenstein, and many more, enriched the Summit. Their contributions spanned workshops, panel discussions, and keynote speeches, offering insights into various facets of humanitarian aid and crisis response.

The call to action was clear: Empowerment begins with you; recognize your capacity to drive positive change and take practical steps, however small they may be, to make it happen.





Networking

In 2023/24, the Circle of Young Humanitarians participated in several events to present our work and raise awareness about our mission. These opportunities are always great for engaging with young people who share our values.

In the second half of 2023 Kim, Nilani and Kay participated in the Female Innovation Forum, where they explored innovative approaches to global challenges and engaged in insightful discussions with leaders from various fields. In winter the CYH had the honour of meeting Dr. Jürg Kesselring, an ICRC doctor, whose experiences in conflict zone medical care enriched our understanding of humanitarian principles. The CYH was also featured in the Ladies Drive magazine, further amplifying our mission and the impact of young humanitarians. Lastly, Kay talked about the dynamic perspectives of today's youth on International Humanitarian Law (IHL) in the ICRC Humanity in War Podcast. Through these events we were able to present our organization to different audiences and broaden our reach within the community. We are grateful for these opportunities to showcase our work and connect with other people who are passionate about humanitarian action. Thank you!



Community Engagement 2023/24

In addition to our regular meetings, we also organize a monthly social get-together to strengthen team bonding and to celebrate our achievements. During two Circle weekends a year in spring and fall, we come together to reflect on our progress, plan for the future and have some fun team-building activities. While the 2023 Circle Day Fall Edition was held at the Pfadiheim on the Uetliberg, we spent the weekend of the 2024 Spring Edition at Food Zurich.





Finances

In the financial section of our annual report, we present an overview of the Circle of Young Humanitarians' fiscal performance throughout the year 2023. We thank all donors and supporters for your continued support.

Erfolgsrechnung 2023

HumCha 23 Einnahmen	CHF	-
HumEnr 23 Einnahmen	CHF	1,553
Summit Einnahmen	CHF	17,257
Sponsoring Einnahmen	CHF	53,824
Total Einnahmen	CHF	72,634

Administration	CHF	-5,730
HumCha 23 Ausgaben	CHF	-
HumEnr 23 Ausgaben	CHF	-1,714
Spenden Ausgaben	CHF	-6,299
Summit Ausgaben	CHF	-29,170
Spesen	CHF	-269
Merch	CHF	-
Total Ausgaben	CHF	-43,182

Jahresgewinn **CHF** **29,452**

Bilanz per 31.12.2023

Umlaufvermögen		Fremdkapital	
Liquide Mittel	CHF 93,473		
Anlagevermögen		Eigenkapital	
		Vereinsvermögen	CHF 64,021
		Jahresgewinn	CHF 29,452
Total Aktiven	CHF 93,473	Total Passiven	CHF 93,473

Outlook 2024/25

The Circle of Young Humanitarians is looking forward to an exciting year ahead in 2024/25. One big focus will be the third Young Humanitarian Summit that will take place on March 22 and 23, 2025. In addition, we have many other ideas and projects that we hope to develop and bring to fruition in the coming year. As our organization continues to grow and evolve, we aim to expand our reach and influence beyond the region of Zurich. Finally, we are excited to explore new areas of focus beyond events. Stay tuned for more exciting developments from the Circle of Young Humanitarians in 2024/25!

Thank you!

The Circle of Young Humanitarians

